

Small Business Cybersecurity Readiness Checklist

A practical review of identity, devices, email, backups, network security and employee access.

PURPOSE

Find the gaps before they become business problems

Use this checklist to quickly identify whether a business has the basic controls needed to reduce common cyber risk. A "no" answer does not always mean a system is failing, but it does indicate an area that should be reviewed before it becomes a business problem.

HOW TO USE IT

Ten checks, one honest answer each

- 1 Answer with whoever manages your IT, accounts and devices.
- 2 Mark **Yes**, **No** or **Unknown** for each check.
- 3 Write the owner, and any evidence, on the notes line.
- 4 Count your No and Unknown answers and read the guide on the last page.

WHAT'S COVERED

Three areas, ten checks

- | | |
|-------|--|
| 01–04 | Identity and devices. MFA, stale and shared accounts, device inventory, encryption and endpoint security. |
| 05–07 | Email, backups and network. Phishing and impersonation filtering, restore testing, secure remote access. |
| 08–10 | People and process. Onboarding and offboarding, security awareness training, leadership reporting. |

01 Security readiness review

Identity and devices

4 CHECKS

C01	IDENTITY	Are all users protected by MFA, especially administrators?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown
NOTES / OWNER			
C02	IDENTITY	Are stale accounts, former employees and shared logins removed or controlled?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown
NOTES / OWNER			
C03	DEVICES	Does the business have an accurate device inventory?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown
NOTES / OWNER			
C04	DEVICES	Are laptops and desktops encrypted and protected by endpoint security?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown
NOTES / OWNER			

Email, backups and network

3 CHECKS

C05	EMAIL	Are phishing, impersonation and malicious attachments filtered?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown
NOTES / OWNER			
C06	BACKUPS	Have backups been restored and tested recently?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown
NOTES / OWNER			
C07	NETWORK	Is remote access secured without exposing unnecessary services?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown
NOTES / OWNER			

People and process

3 CHECKS

C08	POLICIES	Is onboarding and offboarding documented and repeatable?	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown
NOTES / OWNER			

C09

TRAINING

Do employees receive security awareness training?

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

C10

REPORTING

Does leadership receive recurring security and technology reporting?

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

02 Reading your answers

Count the checks you marked **No** or **Unknown**. This is a rule of thumb for deciding what to do next, not an assessment or a score of your security.

NO + UNKNOWN

WHAT IT SUGGESTS

0-2

Basic posture may be acceptable, but should still be validated.

3-5

Schedule a focused security review.

6 or more

Treat it as a priority risk review before a preventable issue becomes expensive.

NOTES AND FOLLOW-UPS

NEXT STEP

Request a Cyber Risk Assessment

If several items are unknown or marked no, a Cyber Risk Assessment shows what is exposed and whether you need a targeted standalone service or broader managed IT and security ownership through the ProActive Ecosystem.

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Educational checklist. It does not assess or certify any environment. This document names no customers and makes no vendor-specific claims.